

7. Add your blog feed to your My Yahoo! and My MSN accounts. This will get you listed on Yahoo! and MSN.

5.2.2 Your Own Hosted Blog

If you're using your own hosting, SEO becomes much easier thanks to the number of options you have. WordPress, for one, offers you its own CMS which you can deploy on your server, and there are a lot of things you can do with it.

SEO And WordPress

To optimise your WordPress blog, use the following tips:

1. **Permalinks Again:** By default, links to posts in your blog will look like this: <http://www.yourblog.com/?p=11>. Search engines don't like this much, so go to Options > Permalinks in your admin panel and in the Custom text box, enter `"/%category%/%postname%"` to change the link's appearance to http://www.yourblog.com/technology/phone_review. This makes your blog not only SEO-friendly, but reader-friendly as well.

This applies to all CMSes, in fact—most of them support SEO-friendly URLs, either as an inbuilt feature or using a plugin—you just need to make sure that the Web server supports URL renaming.

2. **Edit The Page Title:** By default, your page title (the one you see in the search pages) goes thus: Blog Name | Archive | Post Title. You want to bring the post title to the beginning, so search users can instantly know that they've found what they were looking for. To do this, you need to replace this code in `header.php`:

```
<title><?php bloginfo('name'); ?> <?php if ( is_single() ) { ?> ? Blog
Archive <?php } ?> <?php wp_title(); ?></title>
```